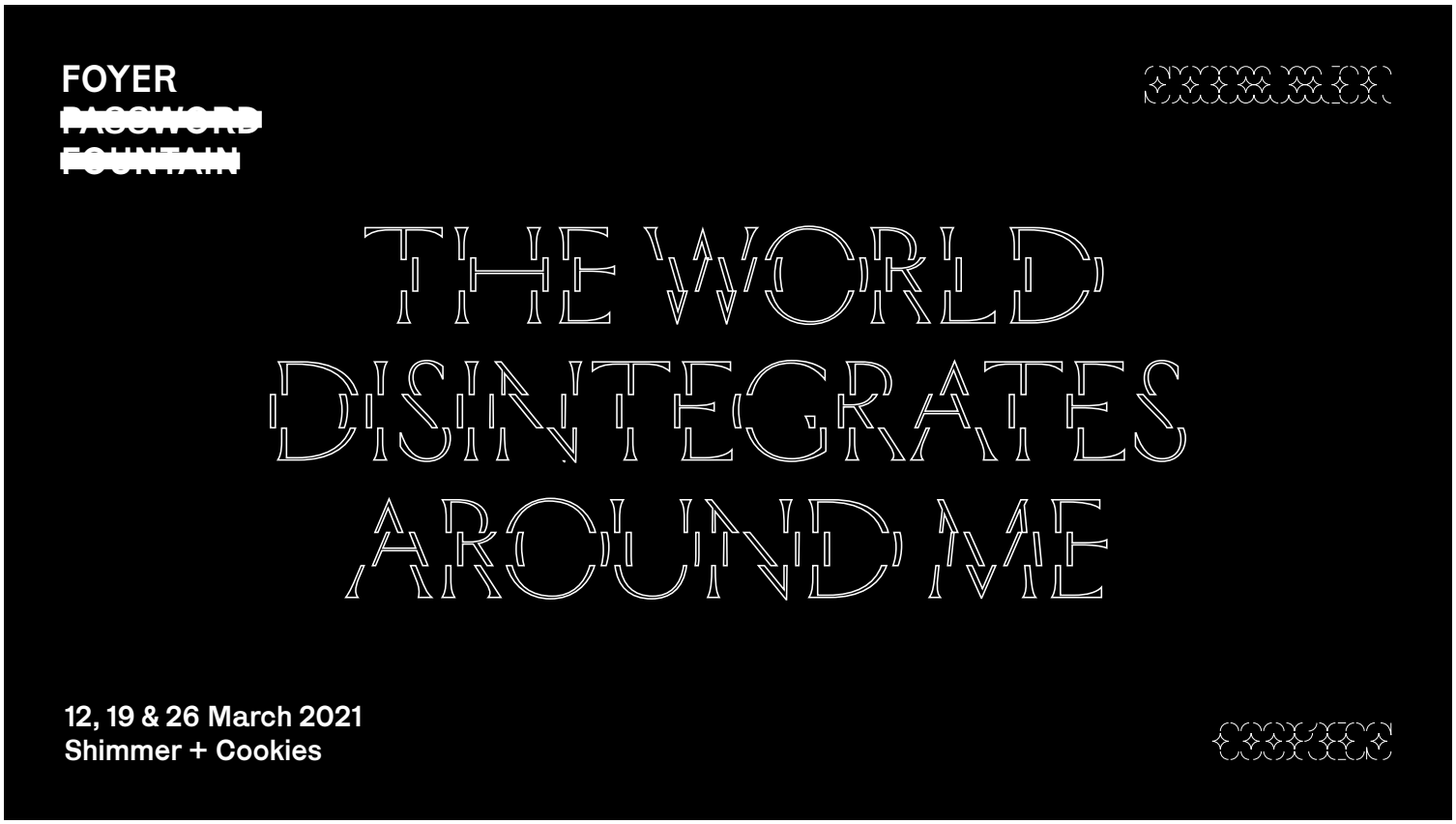


CONTINUOUS MUSEUM

cookies

“A museum for me is something that really transcends the physical architecture”

Bart van der Heide, March 12, Foyer



“Architecture still feels more obviously connected to power than art does.”

Nicholas Korody, March 12, Foyer

“The Foyer is the only place you talk about the exhibition context”

Nicholas Korody, March 12, The Foyer

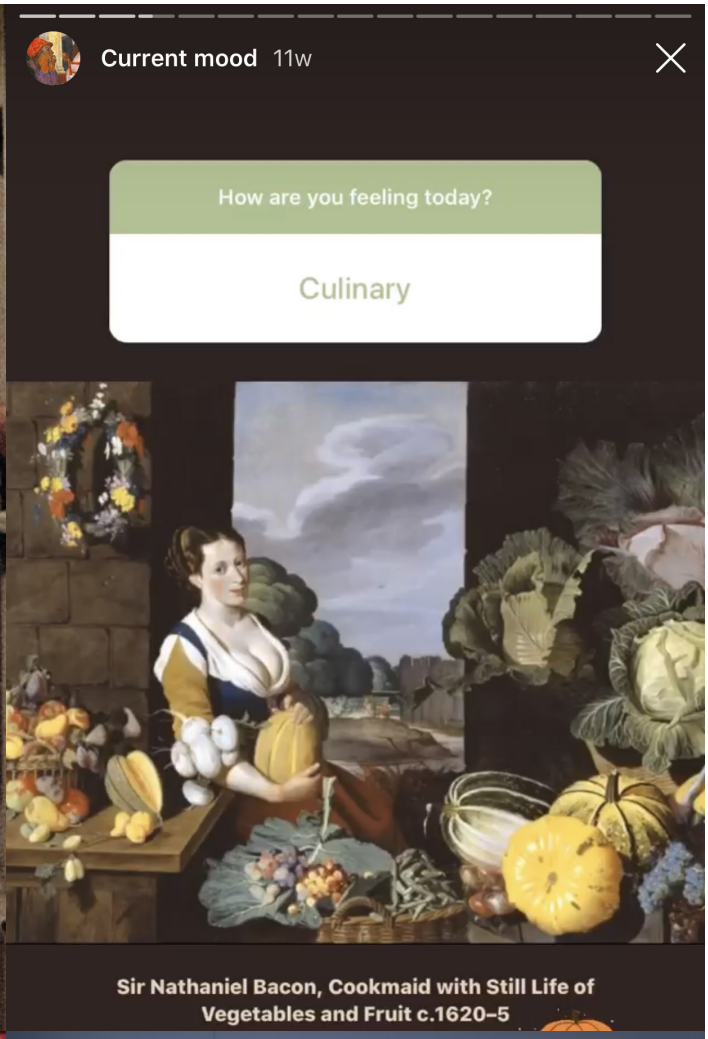
INTRODUCTION

Our aim with this project is to develop prototypes for new infrastructures to exhibit art in the city today. While strongly believing in the role of architecture as fundamental to the perception and experience of art, we propose you to develop new models that combine architecture with the full potential of the digital to open up possibilities for new types of cultural institutions. Following a first research phase during which Cookies organised a series of digital roundtables with curators, artists, museum directors and designers, this studio will be focused on creating prototypes that respond to this research. This design studio will form part of the research of a larger project organized by Cookies and Shimmer.

“It’s like I’m floating the artwork on the river, and I have no control after I let it go.”

Yehwan Song, March 19, Password


Virtual Views
3d
Thursday, 8 p.m.
Virtual Views: Gordon Parks, a Live Q&A
Join us for a live conversation with curator @thesarahmeister and scholars @nifleetwood & @kgibransr.


Current mood 11w
How are you feeling today?
Culinary
Sir Nathaniel Bacon, Cookmaid with Still Life of Vegetables and Fruit c.1620–5


F. Kunath 13w
Swipe up
to watch the full episode with @friedrichkunath .


DESIGN TOUR The collection - Stedelijk BASE (1920-1970) | curator Ingeborg
stedelijkmuseum
1 May
LIVE TOURS

“The concept of the exhibition space to create the environment around the artwork is kind of gone.”

Yehwan Song, March 19, Password

When Covid-19 first unfolded, architecture became a threat: public spaces closed down and cultural institutions rushed their online presence, exposing the flattening and superficial effect of digital platforms as institutions tried to adapt their programming to the new normal. In the last few years however, many artists have been looking at the complex dynamics of how the digital is changing us. Some artists are investigating the role of the digital in our emotions and perceptions, while others are using the digital as another creative space. For example, indigenous communities are using gaming platforms to tell traditional stories and reclaim their own narrative, while many queer artists are exploiting digital potential to speculate on new forms of community building. This shows the breadth with which digital space can be used as a vehicle for storytelling, art, and community which has been largely missed since the pandemic accelerated a dependence on corporate platforms such as Zoom and Instagram.

Our belief is that the digital does not replace the spatial experience of displaying art, but it is an inevitability that must be harnessed. We must therefore consider how digital formats can be structurally integrated in the creation of new ways of exhibiting. Social media platforms, especially Instagram and Facebook, have changed the ways that art is disseminated in the public sphere. The algorithms that govern these platforms are driven by clickbait logic, specifically designed to grab our attention. This raises questions of how a museum is supposed to respond: harness digital platforms to create more meaningful engagement with critical ideas, or step away from them altogether?

The digital realm reveals some possible alternatives for the disintegration of art institutions in the urban fabric – however, an obtuse belief in the digital risks failing to acknowledge the importance of the physical and spatial experience of art on display. Digital applications and websites can help centralise information and assist with navigation but at present, they lack an inherent ability to produce spatial experiences. Therefore, an important aspect of this studio will be to consider the role of the digital in new and unexpected ways.

Fundamentally, this project aims to disintegrate the walls of the museum, both physically and digitally, and try to think of how a museum that collects and interprets cultural production could exist through the city in a decentralised way. This is not a call to bring down museums but to propose an alternative architecture through which museums can exist. An architecture that acknowledges the new post-Covid spatial limitations but that also fully grasps emerging ways of production, interpretation and distribution of art.

Museums are constantly forced to become bigger and more visible, using architecture as a vehicle for their representation as they endeavour to make their presence known in the city. In this project we ask ourselves if this is strictly necessary; are institutions actually condemned to produce ever bigger buildings just to host blockbuster exhibitions? When we look at examples of contemporary art museums we come across examples such as the Tate Modern extension where, under the faceted envelope, stands a stack of orthogonal generic exhibition spaces. The interstitial space between both becomes the circulation and these seem to be the only spaces where some expression is allowed to the architect. The agency for the architect is purely on the outer shell of the building, the foyer and circulation areas while the exhibition rooms stay largely generic, completely disregarding their architectural and local context. The fact that museums are so often identified as a specific building archetype condenses the richness of art and culture into a generalised and somewhat sterile idea of how art should be represented. The disruptions related to Covid-19 shutting institutions for the best part of a year have given us a fundamentally different understanding of the role of institutions as a physical presence in our cities. Moreover, the social tensions and widespread waves of demonstrations demanding an end to structural racism over the past year have caused a deeper reflection on how museums and institutions conceptualise themselves altogether.

We are convinced that this historic moment can serve as an opportunity to reshape our relation to art production and display. We are excited by the opportunity to propose new shapes for museums to exist, tackling not only the new social distancing demands, but the need to develop a structural and architectural approach that will physically intersect with communities and that will include a broader definition of art.

Museums are institutions that call for equality and democracy, but often fail to attract the widest range of visitors through their doors. The new architectures that we expect to develop will address museums as institutions that become stronger and more welcoming as they disintegrate throughout the city. By not relying on precedents set by traditional institutions, a distributed disintegrated institution will serve as a new typology with an ability to reach new publics that are not typically attracted to galleries or museums.

“Many of my friends have dogs, but they can never take their dog to the museum because it has no access to this public building.”

Nico Dockx, March 19, Password



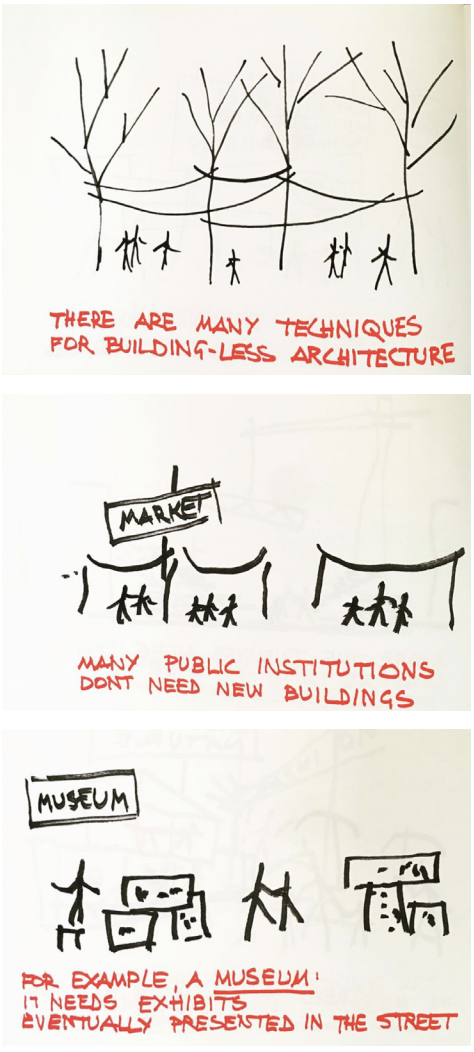
In order to create spatial, bodily experiences, architecture will always have a fundamental role. How can we exhibit and collect art without the need for the walls of an institution? Detaching art from institutional contexts in itself is not new, and there are a number of engaging references from the last century that will help shape this project. Some of our primary inspirations come from the conceptual artists in the 60s and 70s, such as the curator Lucy Lippard, who championed both conceptualism and Land Art – both movements that tried to make it away from artifacts and institutionality. Meanwhile, Sol Lewitt created many artworks through instructions, helping to reassess the role of the author altogether. We are sincerely interested in how these precedents can gain a new relevance today, and how their relationship to new forms of production might be re-evaluated when applied through digital technologies.

Since the arrival of the digital era there have been many curatorial efforts that have been questioning the hierarchical and validatory role of museums and have focused their presence entirely in the digital space. These new types of institutions have decided to completely dispense with the role of architecture. With this project we will reclaim the role of space and architecture for the perception of art.

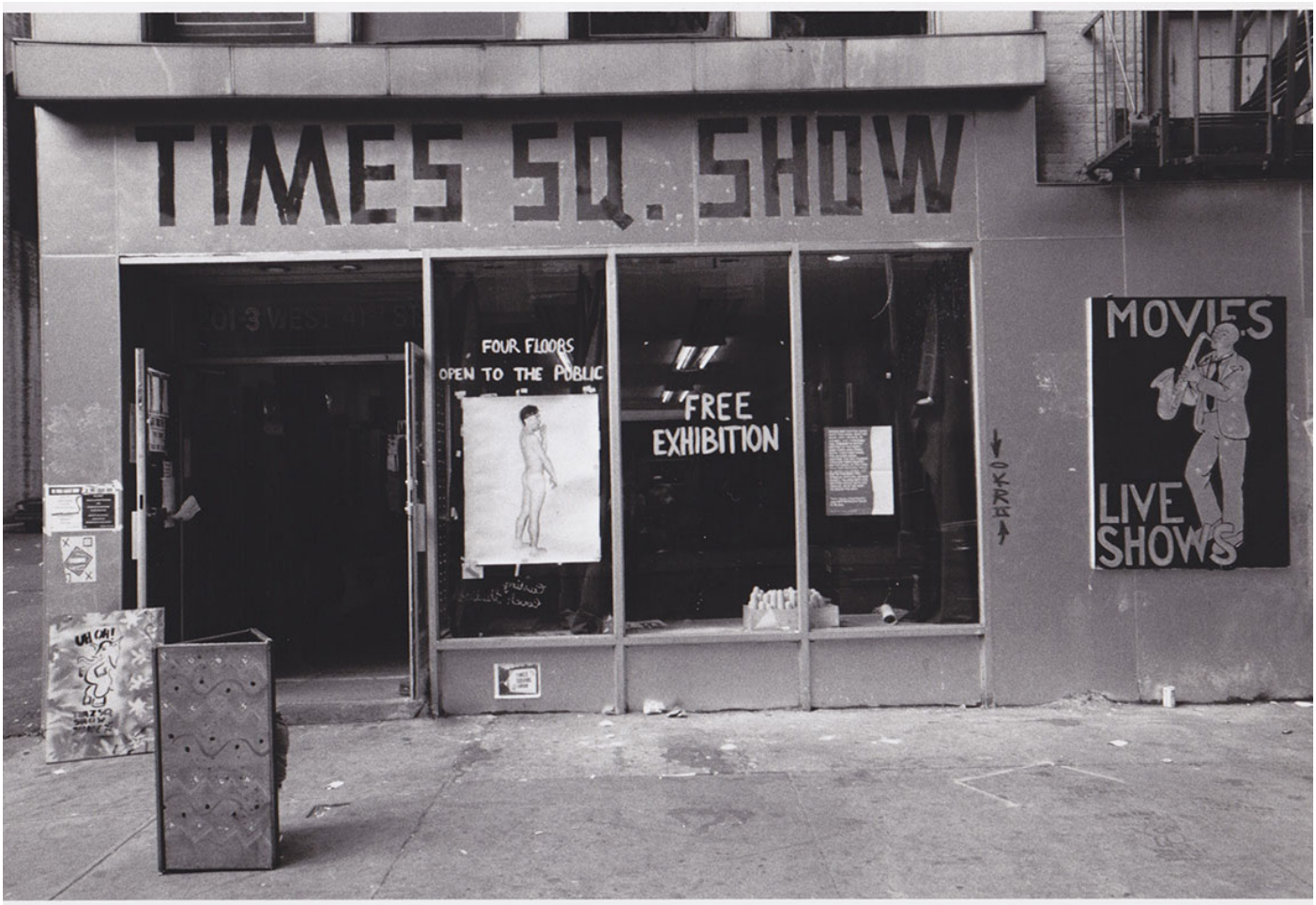
MUSEUM COLLECTIONS

There are a number of important considerations regarding the history and ongoing interpretation of museum collections. Since the 18th Century, museums have been created as public institutions that would preserve the cultural evidence of humankind, often in grand buildings which continue to have a presence as architectural landmarks. However, this tradition of collecting and display also served to preserve the desired narratives projected by different colonial powers and nation states. Objects stolen from faraway lands were typically presented through a lens of exotic otherness to show the expansive reach of colonial empires. Even today, objects in permanent collections of museums are often displayed without proper context, typically disregarding the ways that their provenance was intertwined with colonial violence and extraction. Calls for repatriation of cultural artefacts to their rightful owners have become increasingly common, yet many museums remain stubbornly attached to their collections, causing ongoing international disputes. This ongoing history reaffirms our belief that it is necessary to re-imagine the structure of museums and their embedded hierarchies altogether by proposing a new alternative.

In addition to collections on display physically, many large institutions have gone to great lengths to digitally archive their collections. This raises interesting questions about accessibility, and whether having such artefacts available



Drawings by Yona Friedman



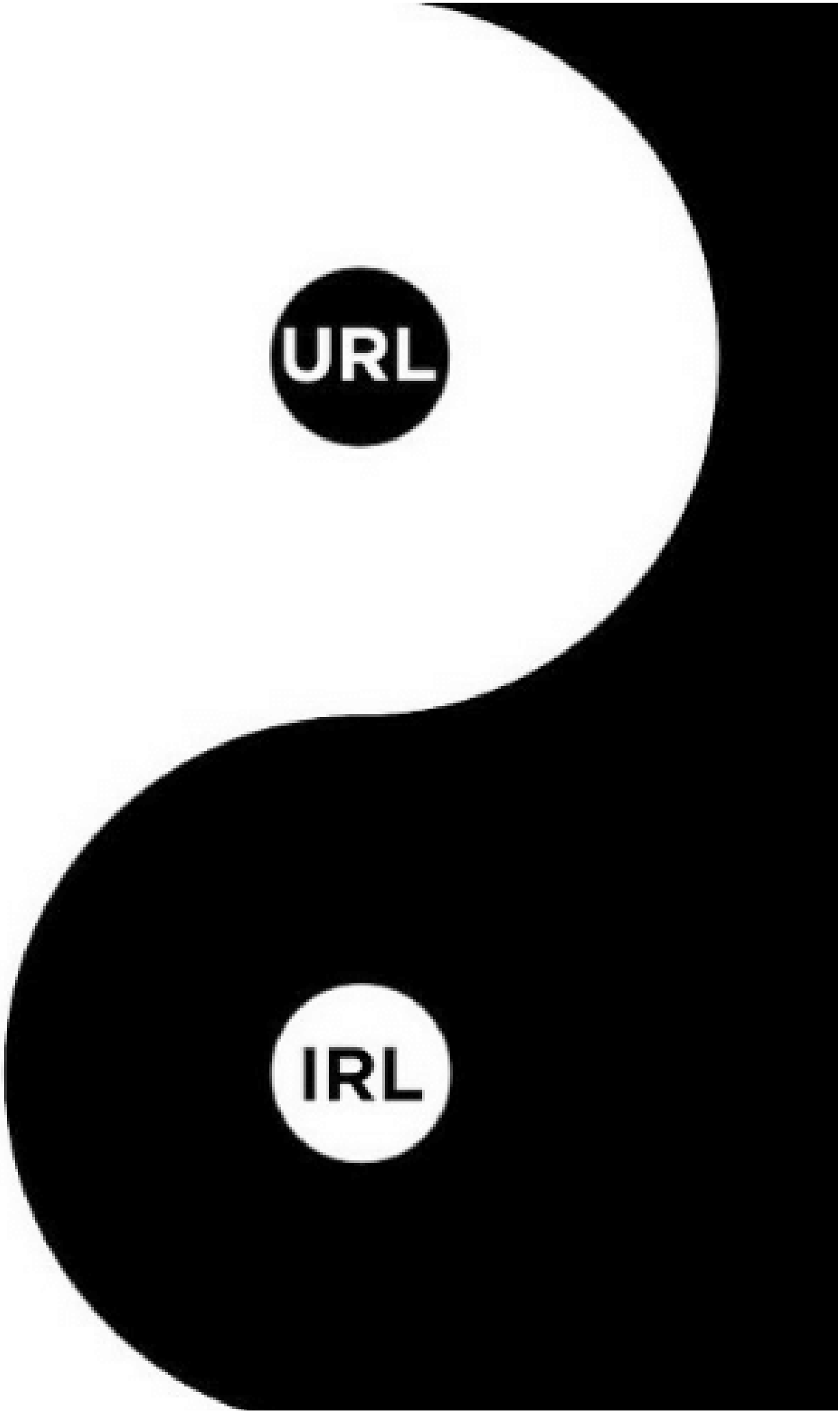
Group Material, Times Square Show (1980)

to view online can in fact democratise their collections by making virtual versions of their artefacts available to the public. This has become increasingly relevant since the devastating fire that destroyed much of the permanent collection at Brazil's Museo Nacional in 2018: in the years preceding the fire, hundreds of the museum's artefacts had been 3D scanned, raising interesting debates around whether or not they could be 3D printed in an attempt to recover lost heritage, while reaffirming the importance of digital archiving.

With this experimental exercise we want to ask what does it mean to have an art collection that is part of an institution that is disintegrated through the city. This collection has the potential of much more accessibility and much less costs associated with its preservation. From an architectural and urban perspective, what does it mean to collect and preserve in the city? Can this approach to a new type of cultural institution give us tools to also preserve the city in different ways?

A traditional approach to urban preservation tends to quantify value according to how important a specific part of the city is. The calculation of value is similar to how social media and algorithms define what is liked and valued, through numeric and quantifiable data. We propose that digital tools can also be used to randomize the selection of collectables, creating an unexpected set of places in the city that are unintentionally selected and therefore statistically more truthful to the conditions in the city.

"The Foyer is a place of the not-yet and the already-been"
Bettina Korintenberg, March 12, Foyer


URL
IRL

PROCESS

The studio will be led on Wednesdays and the starting time is 10:00.

Weekly updates: Every week students must send a progress document. This should include experiments, sketches, references, collages and presented in a manner that makes a narrative sense. It doesn't have to be sleek but must be easily readable. These documents will count towards the final assessment, so please make sure you are consistently delivering these.

Art Club: At the beginning of every session we will allow 30 minutes to discuss the artist or text of the week.

Are.na: We will use Are.na as our platform to share references and material. Are.na is a great source of visual inspiration that allows you to create channels that contain blocks. Blocks in are.na can be links, pdfs, jpegs, gifs, google docs or plain text. We will work on collective channels but you can also have your own channels running in parallel and you decide when you link your blocks to the collective channels. At the moment we have created:

(https://www.are.na/federico-martelli/continuous-museum) - for general inspiration links, images, case studies, videos, lectures, etc

SYNTHETIC OUTLINE

Part I: (30%)

Research, analysis and representation.

Students will work on four teams. Teams will develop a study of the urban context in the Waalhaven including spatial analysis, infrastructure potential, communities present, interpretation of the existing data, interpretation of collected data and representation of the site and case. Special attention must be given to new and attractive ways of representing the case study. Focus on specific conditions, such as light, darkness, terrain, accessibility, smell, internet cover, surfaces, use, noise, sounds, etc.

The digital can also be analyzed here as part of the site, in other words, what is Waalhaven's virtual presence. Existing virtual sites that link to Waalhaven that can also be viewed as spaces of analysis and identity.

Consider also the different communities in the area, including residents as well as different types of activities. Perhaps environmental conditions, biodiversity, contamination, etc.

Learning Outcome: The student should be capable of analysing the context and the site looking critically at the issues at stake. The student should be able to proactively research and study the area and create qualitative data that will allow them to understand the brief better. The student should demonstrate that observations are based on research and interactions with the stakeholders.

Submission must include:

Wide and expansive research on the location: Diagrams, developed sketches, texts, photographs, technical drawings, data, quotes, references, books, material samples, etc.
5 - 10 minute video with site study, interviews, observations, illustrations, including proof of fieldwork.
2 plates A0 for a presentation with a visual representation of the place and with the observations.



Part II: Final project. (70%)

Prototype proposals for new display strategies.

Based on their group research, students will choose a location and will develop an exhibition strategy. The task for this phase is to develop a strategy to create what Carol Duncan calls ‘the ritual dimension in the perception of art’. The objective is not to present a specific artwork but focus on design strategies that can create the psychological preparation for the cognitive experience.

Innovative ways of interactivity, synchronization and overlaps between the physical and digital are encouraged. Explore creative new ways in which we as designers can create alternative experiences and solutions.

Depending on the approach, the design will have to be detailed as far as to allow a good understanding of its feasibility in technical, and financial terms. Materials, technologies (where needed), digital interfaces will have to be understood and explained. Innovative use of technology are appreciated.

A physical prototype at the appropriate scale is requested.

Learning outcome: Students will understand how their skills in design and interior design can be applied to a very contemporary issue, that of the future of the museum. Museums are crucial institutions in our democracies and their futures are linked.

With the opportunity to act within a real site location, the students will also learn how to articulate urban, architectural and public constraints and concerns into a project in a critical way.

Technically, through drawing and prototyping, the students will be able to apply their skills, and develop new skills with a precise goal. The interior design discipline is put at the forefront through this studio, since the students must explore ways in which we can affect and facilitate emotions.

Submission must include:

Presentation. This can be oral, virtual, performative or experimental.
5 – 10 plates explaining the project, including a coherent narrative and visualizations on how the space will be used.
Physical installation on site of a 1:1 mock up or a full 1:20 model.
Printed handout or link with the project and research.
Scaled drawings including detailing of connections and construction techniques.



Kazuo Shiraga, Challenging Mud, 1955.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Refer to the MIARD Handbook for a complete overview of the final competencies (exit qualifications) that are established in accordance with national and international guidelines. These are the skills that enable students to enter the professional field and work on their own or in interdisciplinary collaborative teams.

Seven points

Creative ability: They understand complex issues affecting their field of practice and look beyond disciplinary norms with a critical, imaginative and flexible approach to their work. They seek to impact the field of interior architecture and spatial practice.

Capacity to conduct self-directed research: They can identify relevant subject matter, questions, and methods to formulate a position and distinct areas of research, design and writing.

Critical reflection and awareness of context: They can critically reflect and analyze issues relevant to their field of practice across a broader social-cultural, historical and theoretical context. They are able to make informed decisions about the circulation of their work among these contexts.

Communicative skills: They can clearly communicate their intent, context, process and research through different formats and media to professional and general audiences.

Capacity for media and technology: They approach media analytically and employ novel technologies. They use tools inventively to affect their practice, the profession and society.

Making and material ability: They are able to creatively execute fabrication processes, techniques and material research across a specificity of scales and contexts.

Organizational skills: They demonstrate a comprehensive ability to self-organize, plan, manage and execute complex and creative projects effectively on their own and in collaboration with others at a professional level.

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Inside the White Cube: The Ideology of the Gallery Space, Expanded Edition, Brian O'Doherty, University of California Press, 1999 - 113 p

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Culture Strike: Art and Museums in an Age of Protest, Laura Raicovich, Verso Books, 15 jun. 2021 - 224 p

The City in the City, Florian Hertweck (Editor), Sebastien Marot (Editor), Lars Muller, 2013

Catherine Wood, The Mind is a Muscle, Ivonne Rainer, Afterall Books, 2007

Merce Cunningham, (ed) Germano Celant, Edizioni Charta, 1999

Pasolini's Bodies and Places, (ed) Michele Mancini and Giuseppe Perrella, 2017

Six Years: The Dematerialization of the Art Object from 1966 to 1972, Lucy R. Lippard, University of California Press, 30 Apr 1997 - Art - 272 p

STUDIO CALENDAR

PART I

Week 1, Sept.22nd 2021
STEDELIJK MUSEUM AMSTERDAM 10:00 (Clement online)
STUDIO PRESENTATION. Visit of the museum

Week 2, Sept.28th 2021
STUDIO 11:00 (Federico Online)
Site Visit to SHIMMER (TBC)
Further research material. Include historical research. Sketches, plans, sections, elevations, diagrams. Sketch a mood board and a storyboard for the final presentation.

Week 3, Oct.6th 2022
STUDIO 10:00 (Federico Online)
Guest: Fiontan Moran (TBC)
Team reviews: Pin-up presentation of research material, this should include one plan, one section and one axonometric view (please be creative in the way you represent your research!).
All in A0 (therefore with details, textures, hatches, etc). Desk reviews of presentation material.

Week 4, Oct.13th 2021
PRESENTATIONS PART I 10:00
Final presentation Part I. Presentations and discussion.

MIDTERM BREAK

PART II - Final Project

Week 6, Oct.27th 2021
STUDIO 10:00
Guest: Alessandro Bava (TBC)
Individual presentation of ideas, sketches, diagrams, approaches. Collective conversation. Potential synergies between projects.

Week 7, Nov.3rd 2021
STUDIO 10:00
Guest: Nicholas Korody (TBC)
Identification of the approach. Project development in 2D, 3D, hand sketch, coding, physical and diagrammatic.

Week 8, Nov.10th 2021
STUDIO 10:00
Individual review of progress. Presentation of development and approach.
Formal definition of the projects.

Week 9, Nov.17th 2021
STUDIO 10:00
Project development.
Desk reviews on early design ideas. Diagrams, drawings, plans, sections, elevations.

Week 10, Nov.24th 2021
STUDIO 11:00
PROGRESS REVIEW
Project development.
Pin - up reviews on design ideas. Drawings, plans, sections, elevations . Small-scale models. Material approach and fabrication strategies.

Week 11, Dec. 1st 2021
ONLINE 10:00
Project development.
Individual reviews. Materialization of the project. Materiality and fabrication planning.

Week 12, Dec.8th 2021
IRL 10:00
Individual reviews. Construction. Materialization of the projects.

Week 13, Dec.14th and 15th 2021
ON SITE 11:00
Final reviews.